

Is New PSG More Sustainable?

Has PSG become more efficient and sustainable after moving away from its superstar-centered strategy?

Introduction:

Paris Saint-Germain was known for its superstar-focused strategy during the Messi, Neymar and Mbappe era. While the club gained worldwide attention and commercial growth, questions remained regarding financial efficiency and long-term sustainability.

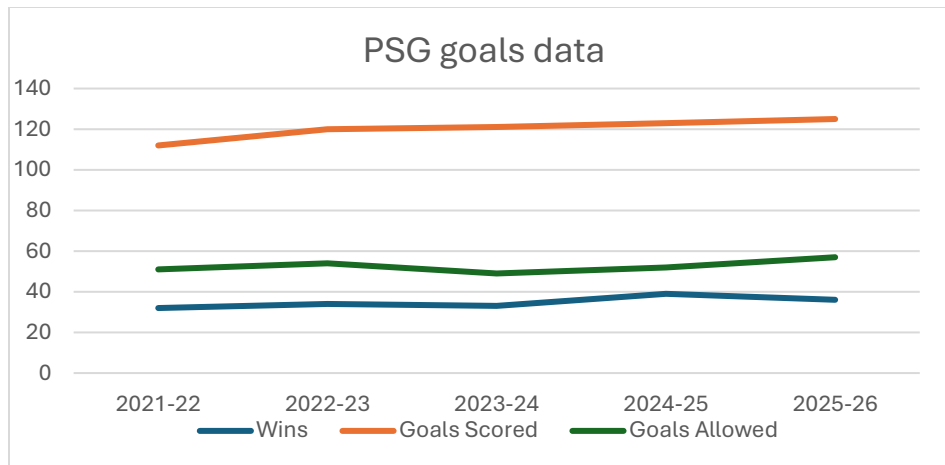
In recent seasons, PSG has shifted toward a younger and more team-oriented approach. This project analyzes whether the new PSG strategy has improved team performance, financial efficiency, squad sustainability and fan engagement.

Finding 1: PSG Maintained Strong Team Performance After the Superstar Era

PSG kept up their top-notch performance through the shift away from a superstar-centric model. Goals scored went from 112 in the 2021-22 season to 125 in the 2025-26 season, while they still won a lot of games. Even after saying goodbye to some superstars, their attack didn't get weaker. Actually, the stats show that more players started scoring goals. Offensive roles spread out within the team instead of hanging on the abilities of one or two stars. This means PSG figured out how to stay really competitive by building a stronger team dynamic.

Business Implication:

On the business side, moving towards this balanced setup allows them to depend less on just a few big names. They manage to keep up excellent results while also ensuring long-term stability.

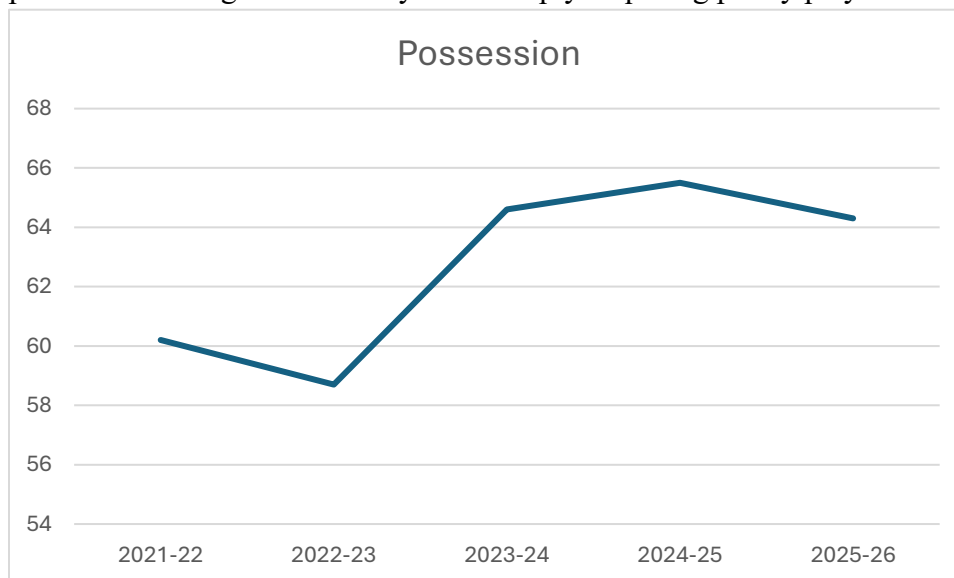


Finding 2: PSG Developed a More Possession-Oriented Playing Style

PSG's average possession rose from 60.2% in the 2021-22 season to 64.3% in the 2025-26 season. Even though possession dipped a bit from 65.5% in 2024-25 to 64.3% in 2025-26, it was still way up from the days of relying on superstar talent. This uptick points to a change in tactics. Instead of counting on big-name athletes for magic moments, PSG seems to be leaning into teamwork. They focus now on controlling games with ball retention and group efforts.

Business Implication:

From a business angle, the numbers suggest PSG is moving towards a model less dependent on one or two stars. With teams owning the ball more, there's potential for better consistency on the pitch and a stronger focus away from simply acquiring pricey player contracts.

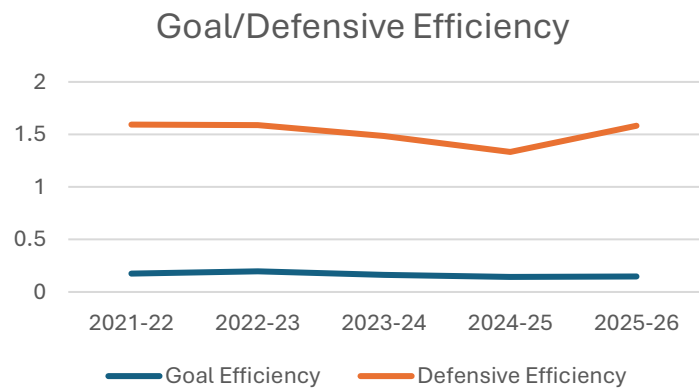


Finding 3: PSG Generated More Scoring Opportunities but Experienced Lower Finishing Efficiency

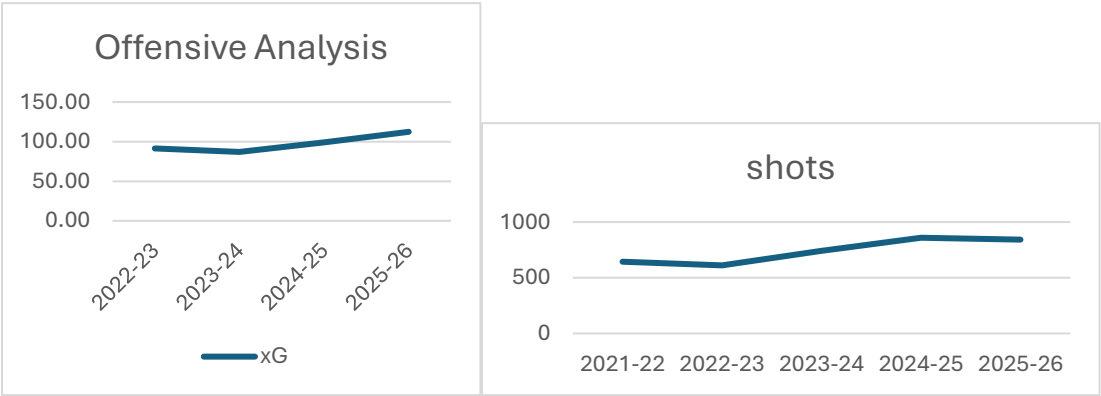
The offensive analysis shows PSG shifted away from relying on a single superstar, changing how they attack the game. Their total shots rose from 645 in the 2021-22 season to over 840 by the 2025-26 season. To boot, their expected goals (xG) went up too—from 87.9 to more than 110. This means PSG is generating a lot more high-quality chances. On the flip side, goal efficiency dropped from 0.174 to 0.143. So while the team creates more shooting chances and better opportunities, they aren’t converting as many of them into actual goals. This suggests PSG now focuses on group effort and sustained attacks. They do create a ton of chances but the excellent finishing from their previous superstar lineup isn't happening as much anymore.

Business implication:

In business terms, improving finishing efficiency would help make the most out of all those



chances PSG generates.

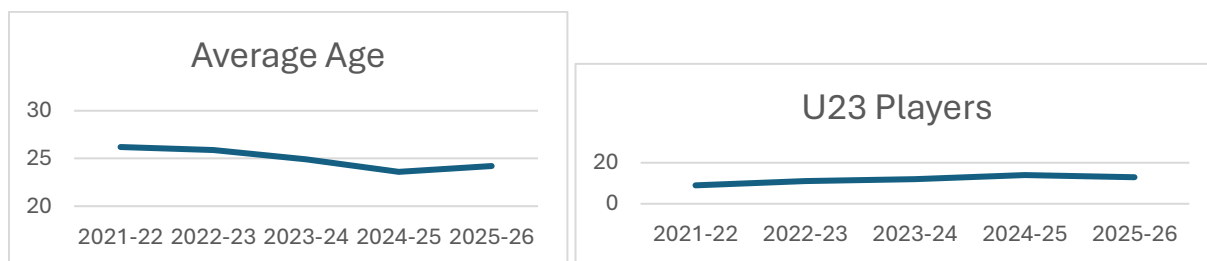


Finding 4: PSG Transitioned Toward a Younger and More Sustainable Squad

The squad age analysis shows a move toward developing younger talent over time. PSG's average squad age dropped from 24.1 years in the 2021-22 season to 23.6 years in the 2025-26 season. Also, the number of under-23 players rose from 9 to 13 during this period. This means that PSG is now integrating more youth into their first team and depending less on star veterans. With a younger team and bigger participation from these up-and-comers, it looks like the club is focusing on growing their squad for the long haul. Having these younger players around gives PSG room to grow talent, increase their market value, and stay financially sound compared to spending big on older pros.

Business Implication:

The info points to PSG creating a more solid and sustainable team setup aimed at lasting success instead of just scoring quick wins with top stars.

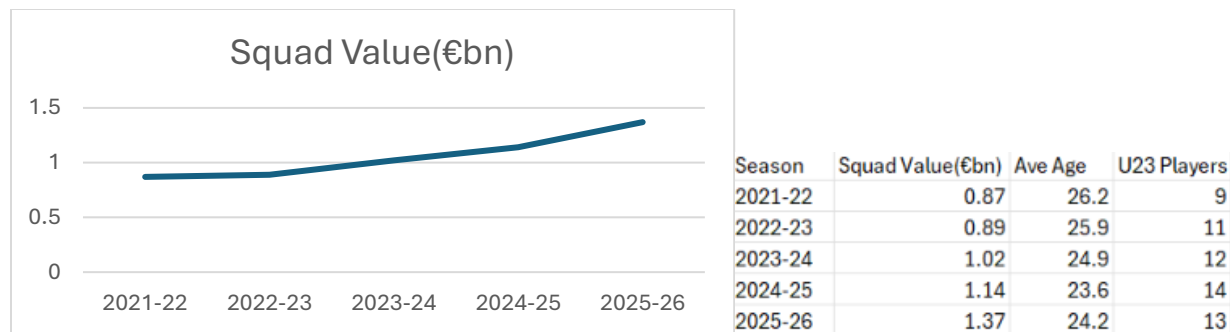


Finding 5: PSG Increased Squad Value While Building a Younger Team

Financial and squad analyses show PSG really boosted both the team's overall worth and their long-term stability too. Their total squad value jumped from €0.87 billion at the start of the 2021-22 season up to €1.37 billion by the 2025-26 season. Also, the team got younger with an average age going down from 26.2 years to 24.2 years. Plus, the number of under-23 players grew from just nine to thirteen. This shift points towards PSG moving away from spending big on top stars to focusing more on developing younger talent. They've found a way to make their squad stronger both financially and in terms of actual performance on the field.

Business Implication:

The business angle here is that this move makes a lot more sense since it sets them up for the long haul. They're building assets with future value all while staying competitive right now.



Conclusion

In this research, we have sought to evaluate if PSG has improved its efficiency and sustainability due to the change from its initial star-based model.

It emerges from our analysis that although PSG continues to demonstrate outstanding results in terms of competitiveness, PSG has succeeded in increasing its opportunities using possession-based strategies. Notwithstanding that its efficiency has dropped, PSG was able to improve its defensive structure and rely less on stars.

Furthermore, PSG increased the overall value of its team through nurturing young talent in its ranks. As it can be seen from our findings, PSG has succeeded in shifting to a more sustainable model, allowing it to reach its goals both in sport and in business.

Recommendations

Considering the results achieved by this research, PSG should definitely keep focusing on nurturing and attracting young talent. The increase in team value with the decrease in mean age proves that it is crucial for not only succeeding at a high level but also ensuring long-term financial stability.

Secondly, PSG should address its finishing problems. While generating higher numbers of shots and achieving better xG values, Goal Efficiency dropped during the research period. PSG needs to consider recruiting finisher or developing the skills of existing attackers to ensure that the scoring potential is maximized.

Lastly, PSG should retain its possession style of play with an emphasis on teamwork. Higher possession rates with stable competitive performance mean that their style of play proved effective in ensuring balance among the lineup and reliance on super star player.